



Introduction to Advertising

Campaign, Conceptualization, and Planning

Hello Viewers,

Welcome to this episode in which we will discuss about the introduction to advertising campaign, conceptualization and planning. The subject expert of this lecture is Dr. Krishna Kumar Kusuma who is currently working as Assistant Professor, in AJK-Mass Communication Research Centre, Jamia Millia Islamia, New Delhi and I am Shivangi Anand.

Introduction to Advertising campaign:

Over the years advertising has become part of every life. It is almost difficult to avoid advertising. They are now persuading you in a variety of forms in both public and private spaces. Advertising is any paid form of non-personal presentation and promotion of ideas, goods, or services by an identified sponsor. Advertisers include not only business firms but also charitable organizations, and government agencies that direct messages to target publics. Ads are a cost-effective way to disseminate messages, whether to build brand preference for any product or to educate people about the social issues.

Advertising campaigns are the groups of advertising messages which are similar in nature. They share same messages and themes placed in different types of medias at some fixed times. The time frames of advertising campaigns are fixed and specifically defined.



According to Collins dictionary "A campaign is a series of advertisements, often with additional events and activities, designed to promote a particular product or brand".

The other definition, according to the Cambridge Business English Dictionary is "A campaign is a planned series of advertisements that will be used in particular places at particular times in order to advertise a product or service and persuade people to buy it or use it".

To understand further, an advertising campaign is a series of advertisement messages that share a single idea and theme which make up an integrated marketing communication (IMC) strategy. Advertising campaigns utilize diverse media channels over a particular time frame and are often mandated to be rationally defined.

The reasons to advertise in terms of a campaign is due to the buyers are forgetful of erratically appearing ads, due to clutter of large number of advertising messages, they overlook several of them. Thus, campaign is a sustained advertising effort. The effective use of coordination, balance, timing, continuity & performance motivates the advertisers to choose an advertising campaign suitable for many goods and services.

Types of advertising campaigns:

There is variety of ways to devise the types of advertising. Campaigns can be classified in terms of media, for example direct mail campaign, newspaper campaign, T.V. Campaign etc. The following is one of the ways to understand the types of advertising campaigns:

Nationwide campaign

These campaigns are for entire nation across languages and geographies.



Regional/statewide campaign

Campaigns are designed for each state/region in a country.

Local campaign

These campaigns are meant for language specific. It will target the audience of specific local communities.

Pioneering campaign

As a part of these campaigns new products or services will be aimed to introduce to the consumers.

Competitive campaigns

This is used by companies as a way to differentiate from their competitors.

Public service campaigns

These are also called social responsibility campaigns. The aim is to benefit the consumers to get awareness and motivate them to adopt better ways of ideas or services.

Objectives of the advertising campaign:

Advertising campaigns are built to accomplish a particular objective or a set of objectives. Such objectives usually include-

- Establishing a brand
- Educate consumers
- Raising brand awareness
- Aggrandizing the amount of sales
- Sharing the information about your product to the people
- Convince the consumers to buy the product
- Make the product is available to the customers



In developing an advertisement campaign, successful firms start by identifying the target market and buyer motives. Then they can make five critical decisions, known as the five 'M's. These will help in formulating the suitable objectives, which are Mission, Money, Message, Media and Measurement.

Mission: In this it is important to know purpose and need of the advertising campaign.

Money: The budget specifications needed to be clear and this will help to bring clarity on the other issues related issues of the campaign.

Message: Designing the suitable message for the right audience is important. The clarity on kind of message content will help design campaign culturally and linguistically viable for the consumers.

Media: Using appropriate media makes the advertising effective. Identifying the best suitable media needed to be discussed.

Measurement: Research is an integral part of any advertisement campaign. This will help to conduct the impact of advertising campaign on the targeted consumers.

Planning and Advertising Campaign:

An advertising campaign plan is a plan to achieve an objective, usually of a large-scale over an extended period of time. It usually coordinates many activities and uses of resources involving multiple organizations. A campaign plan could also have subordinate objectives or intermediate milestones and is often broken down into phases. There are many steps to developing an advertising campaign plan. These steps will vary depending on the type of product or service promoted and the advertising budget.



1. Establish a suitable budget:

A business plan includes operating costs, which should include a budget for advertising. The cost for different advertising methods differs depending on the length of time and extent to which it will be used. Some forms, such as email marketing, cost less than others, such as television, radio and print commercials.

Because there is no fixed cost associated with any one advertising method, develop a budget that fits the needs of the advertiser. There are three ways to establish an advertising budget:

1. Set a gross amount per month or year derived from normal operating costs.
2. Establish a percentage of estimated annual gross sales to dedicate to advertising based on the status of the company and purpose for advertising.
3. Set aside an amount of funding from the general business operations that can be used for advertising on the basis of its need.

Choose whatever will work best for the advertiser or its company and add it to the respective business plan. This ensures that earmarked money set aside for the advertising needs and that business can afford to spend those funds on advertising.

2. Research the Target Audience:

Effective advertising depends on understanding the habits of your targeted audience. To complete this task, review:

- Ad placements directed to the audience: This will tell you how the audience is commonly reached.
- Buying patterns for the product or service: This will help in understanding how often and through what methods the product or service is commonly bought by the consumer.
- The typical location of customers: Sometimes customers might be living in one area or they are spread all over the city



or state. It is important to concentrate the advertising in that area.

- **Timing:** Is your product or service mainly purchased or used during a specific time of year, such as over the holidays? If so, this may dictate when you advertise. Electronic media advertisement needs the right time of the day to be advertised to reach the audience.

These considerations help you narrow down how, when, and where to reach your target audience.

3. Develop an Advertising Media Plan

After setting a budget and researching the customer base, it's time to craft the advertising plan. The advertising methods used depend on the audience and funding. There are several different methods available, including:

- **Print advertisement:** This type of advertising includes anything that can be put on paper, including ads in newspapers or magazines, booklets, direct mail or flyers.
- **Newspaper or magazine ads:** These advertisements reach readers of specific periodicals. The available sizes and costs of ads depend on the publication's popularity, readership, and the area in which it is sold.
- **Booklets:** Booklets are usually distributed to customers by hand, perhaps during an initial consultation. Therefore, this form of advertising reaches only those individuals receiving a booklet. The cost of booklets depends on their size and the amount of formatting required. The booklet advertising is effective when a customer already has familiarity with a product or service.
- **Direct mail:** These advertisements are sent directly to current or potential new customers through the regular mail. They typically consist of a letter or a postcard of



varying size. Their cost depends on printing and formatting expenses as well as mailing charges.

- Flyers: Flyers can be distributed just about anywhere, including parks, other businesses or at special events. They normally consist of a single page that provides the basic information, perhaps in bullet points, of your business. They are one of the less expensive forms of advertising.
- Email advertisement: Similar to a print advertisement, email advertisement directly contacts current or potential customers. An email can contain any and all information you want. Although there is no cost to sending an email, you may have to pay a third-party marketing or advertising company for a mailing list.
- Electronic Media advertisement: This includes radio and television ads. The cost of these ads can be quite high because they require purchasing radio or television slots and putting together either a recording or video to showcase your businesses' products or services. However, if the target audience spends a lot of time in front of the television or listening to radio, this option may be one of the best ways to advertise.
- Online advertisement: Online advertising includes placing banners or other types of ads on web pages. These web pages can be for other businesses, news agencies, or any other type of page that the target audience would visit. Often, the ad contains a link directly to the company's or organization's website.
- There might be other forms of advertising suitable for a specific business.

4. Implement the Plan:

- To reach customers through advertising, Media scheduling has to be done accurately so that the advertisements will be visible or be read or be audible to the targeted customers at the right time. This means that once developed a plan and



choose the means to advertise, it's time to purchase the products and set aside the time need to engage in the advertising campaign.

5. Measure the Results

The final step in any advertising plan is to evaluate how well the plan worked. There are several research methods to evaluate the advertising campaigns and audience. They are:

- Awareness and Recall Testing
- Mall Intercept Method
- Mail Questionnaires
- Telephone Surveys
- Consumer Panels
- Tracking Studies

With the help of research and evaluation the following can be understood for further improvement:

- New customer rates and retention: How many new customers did your business obtain since implementing the plan? Whether the company could retain those customers?
- Current customer retention: Did your advertising keep former customers returning to use your business?
- The changing tastes and preferences of audience

If the benefits of campaign plan are obvious and in the positive, advertising scheme that worked quite well. If, however, the business did not grow as expected, it might be time to revise the budget dedicated to or methods you used for advertising.

Conceptualization an Advertising Campaign:

Creativity in advertising campaign is conceptualized as a function of three dimensions, namely novelty, meaningfulness and connectedness. Novelty and meaningfulness involve info-centric



aspects, while connectedness incorporates the perspective of the audience.

The critical part of making an advertising campaign is determining a 'theme' as it sets the tone for the individual advertisements and other forms of marketing communications that will be used. The campaign theme is the central message that will be communicated in the promotional activities. The campaign themes are usually developed with the intention of being used for a substantial period but many of them are short lived due to factors such as being ineffective or market conditions and competition in the marketplace and marketing mix. Some of the campaigns like Swachha Bharat Abhiyan, Mission Indra Dhanush, save the sparrow etc. have used multiple forms of media to cater the variety of audiences.

The other creative aspects include the message designing for various media. For radio and television requires the script, graphics, location, language dialogues etc. The print and internet advertisement needs graphics, animation, layout design etc. There creative decisions also vary as per the objectives of the advertisement campaign.

Online or digital advertising campaign:

Over the years advertising has adopted to the ever changing communication technologies and new formats of media. Internet technologies have opened new opportunities for advertising. The growing use of various communications devices by the consumers made it necessary to reach them. The dynamics of production, distribution, and consumption of internet or online advertising is different than the print and television advertising. Internet technologies have given variety of communication platforms to reach to the audience directly. A two way process is possible for better consumer appreciation.

According to IMAI-IMRB report India's internet or digital advertising market is projected to grow at a CAGR of 35 per cent



to reach ₹7,044 crore by the end of this year. This growth is huge when compared to the year 2015. The digital advertising market was pegged at ₹5,200 crore at the end of December 2015, accounting for about 12 per cent of the total advertisement spends in the country, the report titled 'Digital Advertising in India' said.

Executing an advertising campaign using any medium can be significantly challenging. The question of whom to target, how to target them, and what message to convey can sometimes leave an advertiser with too many questions to handle. As the inherent nature of the online community is to be wary of promotions or messages on the Internet, it makes the task of delivering the communication even more challenging for the online marketer.

This isn't to say that an effective online advertising campaign can't be pulled off. A company's web presence is a highly important facet of their image and businesses should be utilizing various online advertising vehicles as a part of their overall integrated marketing communications. If a company is pursuing an advertising strategy with billboards and on the radio, they should also be executing this campaign on the web.

Since market research coupled with a certain desired effect or outcome is the factor that binds together all of the advertising mediums, the company may already have a targeted group that are going after from a previous or existing campaign. It may also be that different mediums are targeting different demographics, e.g., radio and television are targeting the older audience while social media is going after the younger generations. Whichever strategy the business is pursuing, be sure to know who are the ads targeting and what is expected them to do as a result of the exposure to the desired message.



Advertising vehicles that can be used online as follows:

Search Engines: Using search engines for advertising purposes is different than search engine optimization (SEO). Instead of getting ranked organically by Google's algorithm, need to pay for the placement of the ad in certain spots on search engine results pages (SERPs). The search results that are typically at the top of the page highlighted in a yellow that seems to be blending in more and more with the background.

Social Media: The blanket term of social media to describe the various vehicles that are Facebook, Whatsapp, Twitter, Pinterest, YouTube etc. for the brevity of this bullet point; however, this doesn't mean that the message should be the same for all of these different platforms. The basic idea is to deliver your message to the fans and followers with the ability of interaction afterward. If a user has a question concerning the message they are able to reply directly which gives the company the chance to answer back immediately.

Email Marketing: Programs like MailChimp, is an email marketing service have made it extremely easy to execute email marketing campaigns. It is important to know that email marketing is that the emails you send out are highly susceptible to being discarded without being read or marked as spam. To minimize this, send out emails only to those people who have opted into receiving the communications or have willingly given their email addresses.

Online Radio: Advertising with online radio stations like Pandora, an internet radio service is a relatively recent development, but can prove to be quite effective if done correctly. More and more people are listening to online radio in their cars or at work, and placing your ad by targeting the right geographical location may prove to be rewarding. With Pandora, advertisers are able to choose between a banner ad or an audio-visual campaign. One limitation to be aware of with online radio is that your targeting is restricted to a set location and suspected age group. This



demographic does not ensure that campaign is reaching the ideal buyer persona.

As is true with any good advertising campaign, more than selling and buying a relationship with the consumer can be established. One of the best advantages of online or digital advertising is to getting the real time statistics about the audience traffic to your campaign. The research cost will come down and improvements can be brought promptly.

Effectiveness of an Advertising Campaign:

The rate of success or failure in accomplishing these goals is estimated via effectiveness measures. There are five key points at which an advertising campaign must consider to ensure an effective campaign. These points are

1. Integrated marketing communication (IMC)
2. Media
3. Positioning
4. The Communication of processes
5. Touchpoints

1. Integrated marketing communication (IMC):

In the integrated marketing, the entire department's in the company work together to serve the customers' interests. Integrated marketing takes place on two levels. First, the various marketing functions like sales force, advertising, customer service, product management, and marketing research must work together. All of these functions must be coordinated from the customer's point of view. Second, marketing must be embraced by the other departments.

Integrated marketing communication ensures that all forms of communications and messages are carefully linked together. It is a concept or approach used by the majority of organizations to



develop a strategic plan on how they are going to broadcast their marketing and advertising campaigns. Nowadays there has been a shift in the way marketers and advertisers interact with their consumers and now see it as a conversation between Advertising or Marketing teams and consumers. IMC has emerged as a key strategy for organizations to manage consumer experiences in the digital age. The more traditional advertising practices such as newspapers, billboards, and magazines are still used, but fail to have the same effect now as they did in previous years.

Advantages of using IMC are that it has the ability to communicate the same message down several channels to create brand awareness. IMC is the most cost effective solution when compared to mass media advertising to interact with target consumers on a personal level.

2. Media:

Media are also known as marketing channels and act as the binding substance used by an advertising campaign to create a connection with the target consumer. Using of social media became imperative these days for each campaign along with the traditional forms of media. Traditional methods of communication with the consumer include newspapers, magazines, Radio, television, billboards, telephone, post and door to door sales to name a few traditional methods. Some of these traditional methods are still very effective for some industries and not so for others.

3. Positioning:

Positioning is an important marketing concept that businesses implement to market their products or services. The positioning concept focuses on creating an image that will best attract the intended audience. When the positioning concept is effective and productive it elevates the marketing efforts made by a business



and assists the buyer in purchasing the product. Effective advertising campaign uses the following positioning concepts:

- Promotion
- Price
- Place
- Product

4. The Communication of processes:

An advertising campaign uses the communication process to ensure all the appropriate steps of communication are being taken in order. The order of operation an advertising campaign examines the flow of communication between a given organization and the consumer. The communication process includes a Sender or Source, message, channel, receiver and feedback. The source is the person or organization that has a message they want to disseminate the information to the potential consumers. Here consumers are receivers. Message is the advertising campaign content and channel refers to the media chosen for campaign.

The external factors acting as distractions, these factors are called noise. Noise distorts the way the message gets to the intended target audience. These distractions are from all other forms of advertising and communication from every other person or organization. Examples of noise are State of mind, unfamiliar language, unclear message, Values, Attitudes, Perceptions, Culture and Knowledge of similar products or services to name a few forms of noise. The noise is a form of distortions that the receiver faces during receiving the message. This communication process in the advertising campaign will also takes care of any 'noise' or communication problems in encoding or decoding the message.

Finally, there is response or feedback. Feedback is the receiver's reaction to the message and the way they understood it. Feedback relates to the way sales react as well as the interest or



questions that arise by the target audience in relation to the message put out. Through continuous feedback and interaction between sender and receiver will be done for reducing the communication problems.

5.Touchpoints:

Hank Brigrman defines a touch point as an influential action initiated by a communication, a human contact or a physical or sensory interaction. Each touch point is a message that literally "touches" a customer in some way. Collectively, touch points create the customer's experience.

These touch points help the brand to develop a point of contact between themselves and the consumer. Modern day advancements in various forms of technology have made it easier for consumers to engage with brands in numerous ways. The most successful touch points are those that create value in the consumer and brands relationship. Common examples of touch points include social media links, Quick Response (QR) codes, the personal handing out flyers about a particular brand, billboards, websites and various other methods that connect the brand and consumer.

Multisensory touch points are subconscious yet help to use and recognize brands through characteristic identified through human sensors. These characteristics could be shape, color, textures, sounds, smell or tastes associated with a given brand. It is important for an advertising campaign to consider sensory cues into their campaign as marketplaces continue to become increasingly competitive and crowded.